

Employee Handbook: Leave & Time-Off Policy (Excerpt)

1. Paid Time Off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue 1.75 days of PTO per month, for a total of 21 days per year. PTO accrual begins on the employee's start date and unused PTO may be carried over up to a maximum of 10 days into the following calendar year. Any balance beyond 10 days is forfeited unless local law requires otherwise.

2. Sick Leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year, separate from PTO. Sick leave may be used for the employee's own illness or to care for an immediate family member. Absences longer than 3 consecutive days require a note from a healthcare provider.

3. Parental Leave

Eligible employees receive 16 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Leave must be taken within 12 months of the qualifying event and may be split into two blocks of at least 2 weeks each with manager approval.

4. Bereavement Leave

Employees are entitled to 5 paid days of bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member and 2 paid days for an extended family member. Additional unpaid leave may be requested through HR on a case-by-case basis.

5. Requesting Time Off

All time-off requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 2 weeks in advance for planned absences exceeding 3 days. Manager approval is required before the leave is confirmed; requests are auto-escalated to the department head if not actioned within 3 business days.